

OLOS — Pre-Cycle Decision Brief

Where we are, how the flow works, and what to decide before the next cohort

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1 · Where we are

OLOS shipped **mid-cycle**. The hard onboarding bugs from the May launch are **fixed in code** (issue #110). The one safety-critical piece that caused the May cascade — the job that marks disengaged people “inactive” — is **turned off**, and must come back on *safely* before the next cohort opens.

Area	State	The read
Sign-in, pulse checks, pod & project registration	Live	Core participant flow is solid
Onboarding state machine (reconciler + admin UI)	Merged	May root cause addressed in code
Revocation cron (auto-marks inactive)	OFF	Rewritten, never validated live, no human-review step
Late-join after pod registration closes	Gap	Engaged-but-slow people can get locked out
Test isolation (safe place to exercise flows)	Gap	Testing risks polluting / revoking real data
Separate dev & prod environments (DBs, Vercel, domains)	In place	dev branch -> dev site/DB; main -> prod site/DB
Promotion gate, CI checks, auto-applied migrations	Missing	dev->main is a manual merge; no CI on PRs; prod migrations run by hand

27 open issues, almost all funneling through two gates: **#110** (onboarding/cron) and **#72** (promotion gate + CI on top of the existing dev/prod split). **Most P0/P1 issues have no owner** — the top process risk.

2 · The cycle journey (where lock-out happens)

Join -> 1 Problem -> 2 Vote -> 3 Pick Pod(s) -> [pod hits min?] -> Pod ACTIVE (you become "active")
-> 4 Propose -> 5 Vote -> 6 Projects finalized -> 7 Pick ONE project -> Build / Showcase

RISK: you never join a pod OR your pod never fills => stuck: never becomes "active"

You are only “**active**” once you’re in a pod that reached its minimum size. The two ways to fall out are exactly what the automated job acts on.

3 · How someone becomes “inactive” (and the safeguards)

ACTIVE --(no active pod after pod-reg close + GRACE)--> WARNING email
ACTIVE --(2 pulse checks missed in a row)-----> WARNING email
WARNING --> 3-day grace --> joins pod / submits pulse --> ACTIVE
 \--> still failing -----> INACTIVE (read-only, reversible)
INACTIVE --(admin reactivate OR re-register / pulse)--> ACTIVE

Safeguards: a **grace window** before “no pod” counts (slow != disengaged) · **warning + 3-day grace** before anyone goes inactive (built) · **report-only mode + admin preview** so an admin sees who *would* be affected before the system acts · **admins/owners exempt** and a **test cycle excluded entirely** · **always reversible**.

4 · What broke in May, and what’s different now

The May job did this	The rewritten job does this
Counted pod membership across all cycles	Looks at only the current cycle
Judged from the wrong start date	Baseline = later of activation or pod-reg open
Acted immediately, silently	Warning email -> 3-day grace -> only then acts
No safe way to test	A test cycle is excluded entirely (sandbox)
Ran live with no preview	Report-only mode + admin preview (<i>proposed, D-1</i>)

Promise we can make the cohort: no one is marked inactive without a warning, a grace period, and a human review — and it is always reversible.

5 · Decision board

Options + our recommended lean. The team **ratifies or overrides** — D-1...D-3 shape the pre-cycle build, so confirming them unblocks everyone.

#	Decision	Options	Lean	Why it matters
D-1	Re-enable the cron — how?	(a) report-only -> preview -> soak -> enforce; (b) re-enable as-is after soak; (c) leave off, nudge by hand	a	The exact May failure surface; a human gate is cheap insurance
D-2	Late join after pod-reg closes (#123)	(a) configurable grace window; (b) moderators add to own pod; (c) admin-only + runbook	a	Decides whether slow-but-engaged people get locked out
D-3	Safe testing of pulses (#122)	(a) is_test flag + hidden sandbox pod; (b) role-based exemption only; (c) literal hidden pod in live cycle	a	Exercise real flows without skewing live data
D-4	Warning email tone (#37)	(a) firm “revoked, refill to regain”; (b) soft “refill anytime, no penalty”	team	Clarity vs. discouraging people; hits everyone warned
D-5	Multi-pod -> multiple pulses? (#97)	(a) one pulse per person; (b) one per pod	team	Shapes pulse data + the “missed 2” trigger

Lower-stakes / can defer: calendar invites (#119), permissions doc (#62), and a guidance note so the late-join grace doesn’t run past Solution-Proposal open.

6 · Trajectory — what must land before the next cohort

	BEFORE NEXT CYCLE (blocking)	DURING THE CYCLE
Safety	#####	
- cron: report-only + preview + grace + sandbox		(#122 #123 #121 #37 + re-enable)
Foundation	#####	
- promotion gate + CI + auto-migrate (dev/prod split already exists)		(#72 #76 #77 #78; #42 -> #43)
Audit trail	#### (#115, before #117)	
Steward tools	#####-----	---> (#117)
Pulse visibility		##### (#51 #87 #86 #97 #38)
Polish & docs		...##### (#120 #106 #105 #119 #65 #62 #99)
	[next cycle start]	

Left of the line = must ship before we open the cohort (Safety + Foundation). **Right = improves the experience while the cycle runs** — none of it blocking.

The one process ask: assign a single accountable owner to every P0/P1 issue today. They’re currently unowned, and unowned high-priority work is how the May cron sat broken.

Meeting flow (15 min): §1+§4 where we are / what we fixed (2m) · §2+§3 walk the flow (4m) · §5 make D-1...D-3, discuss D-4/D-5 (7m) · §6 confirm the line + assign owners (2m).